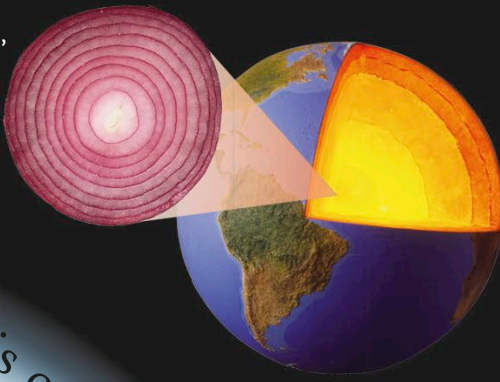


Cut open an onion, and you'll see that it's composed of layers. The Earth has layers too, and they get hotter and hotter the deeper they go.



A moving crust

The Earth's surface layer, or crust, is a shell of solid rock. This crust is broken up into plates, which shift around constantly on a middle layer of molten, or liquid, rock. The Earth's core is solid.



The Earth's plates

Danger zones

The areas where the Earth's plates move against each other are often weak spots where volcanoes and earthquakes are common.



Molten lava erupts from a volcano in Hawaii, which is located where there is a weak place in the Earth's crust.

The Earth is constantly spinning. It takes 24 hours to turn completely on its axis.

The Earth is surrounded by a thin halo – our precious atmosphere.

The Earth is the only planet in our solar system with an atmosphere in which animals and plants (as we know them) can breathe.

Turn and learn
The Earth's atmosphere:
pp. 6-7